



Typegram

This addictive web app turns Instagram's photos into creative typography:
<http://dgit.in/1ERHqux>



Poop alert!!!

Acer demonstrated a new gadget called the DiaperPie that detects the condition of a baby's diaper. Read more: <http://dgit.in/1ddE3Ik>

Bazaar

Xolo Chromebook

The Alternative

Build & Design

The Xolo Chromebook has a good plastic build and an understated design, one that makes use of flat, smooth surfaces and gently angled edges in conjunction. However, the keyboard is surrounded by a glossy transparent plastic panel which looks really cheap. The Xolo Chromebook's 11.6-inch matte display means that you aren't subjected to unnecessary glare and reflections. On the other hand, it has mediocre viewing angles.

Moving to the keyboard, it is solid and every chiclet key has sufficient travel. One issue is that some of the keys tend to slightly jam when they're not pressed on the centre. A bigger issue is that while the Chromebook keyboard is very similar to the Windows keyboard, there are some big differences as well. The most noticeable changes include no delete, caps lock or function keys, and while their functionality can be unlocked with the help of shortcuts, you'll need to learn a whole set of such new shortcuts.

The Xolo Chromebook is relatively heavy at 1.5 kgs but small enough to fit into most knapsacks or satchels.

Chrome OS: A new way to OS

As opposed to the many myths that surround Chrome OS, it isn't merely a browser masquerading as an OS. Yes, the Chrome browser is an integral part of the OS, but it's not the only part. For e.g. Chrome OS has its own file system (accessed with the help of the 'Files' app) and default video and music players (again apps). These apps may not have the features or capabilities of Windows software, but they do exist and they are 'offline' by every definition of the word. The Chrome App Store also has a number of quality apps that can work offline. You may not find the exact offline Windows app for the Chromebook, but chances are you'll be able to find a decent alternative.

Performance

In terms of day to day use, the Chromebook is a stickler to the term "budget performance". You can browse the Web with it but open a slightly heavy website (for instance pixlr.com) and you can immediately make out a dip in performance. One of the best things about the Chromebook is that unless you switch it off, it will remain in an "always on" state, which enables you to use it without any



Price
₹12,999



delays in terms up startup or booting time. Even if you shut down the Chromebook, it's back to a usable state in a matter of seconds.

In our battery test, the Xolo Chromebook was able to last for just over 7.5 hours while playing a full HD movie which means it will be able to just about last a day of regular use.

I know I shouldn't expect from a device that costs this little but when looked at as a primary machine, the Xolo Chromebook's performance falls short by a some distance.

Bottomline

For ₹12,999, there's a lot that the Chromebook does well, but there's also plenty of gaps that it should have ideally filled up.

If you're looking for a laptop to replace your primary Windows machine, look at budget Windows options like the HP Pavilion 14 or the Lenovo G50 instead. If you don't want to go for a large laptop then look at the Asus Eeebook X205ta.

If you want a really inexpensive machine for school or college and you only intend to use it to access Google's productivity tools and some light browsing, then a Chromebook would be ideal for you provided you have a reliable wireless connection but rather than the Xolo, I'd suggest you go for the slightly more expensive HP Chromebook 11.

Want a second machine to complement your main desktop or laptop? You can opt for the Xolo Chromebook if you're already invested in Google's ecosystem and use Chrome as your primary browser. If not, then just buy an iPad. It will be more comfortable to use around the house.

Nikhil Pradhan



Performance.....	56
Features	63
Design & Build	72
Value for Money	57

Specifications

Operating System: Chrome OS; **Screen Size:** 11.6-in at 1366x768 pixels; **Built-In Storage:** 16GB; **MicroSD Card Support:** Yes; **RAM:** 2GB; **Battery:** Li-Ion; **Processor:** 1.8GHz Rockchip RK3288 Quad-Core Cortex-A17

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